Class 6 Social Science – Chapter 5

India, That Is Bharat

इस अध्याय के सभी मुख्य विषयों, पाठ्यपुस्तक के प्रश्नों, गतिविधियों तथा परीक्षा में पूछे जा सकने वाले महत्वपूर्ण प्रश्नों के उत्तर Simple English में दिए गए हैं। उत्तर कक्षा 6 के विद्यार्थियों के स्तर के अनुसार रखे गए हैं।

Part 1: Textbook Questions and Answers

Q1. Discuss what could be the meaning of the quotation at the start of the chapter.

Answer:

The quotation means that India has had spiritual and cultural unity since ancient times. People living in different parts of India shared many traditions, beliefs and cultural practices. The Himalayas and the surrounding seas helped define this region.

Q2. Write True or False.

Statement	Answer
1. The Rig Veda describes the entire geography of India.	False
2. The Vishnu Purana describes the entire Subcontinent.	True
3. In Ashoka's time, 'Jambudvipa' included what is today India, parts of Afghanistan, Bangladesh and Pakistan.	True
4. The Mahabharata lists many regions, including Kashmir, Kutch and Kerala.	True
5. The term 'Hindustan' first appeared in a Greek inscription more than 2,000 years ago.	False
6. In ancient Persian, the word 'Hindu' refers to the Hindu religion.	False
7. 'Bharata' is a name given to India by foreign travellers.	False

Q3. If you were born about 2,000 years ago and had the chance to name our country, what name or names might you have chosen, and why?

Sample Answer:

I would choose the name Bharat because it is an ancient Indian name. It represents our shared culture, traditions and history. I might also choose Jambudvipa, a name used in ancient times for the Indian Subcontinent.

Q4. Why did people travel to India from various parts of the world in ancient times? What motivated them to undertake such long journeys?

Answer:

People travelled to India in ancient times for many reasons:

1. Trade: They came to buy and sell spices, textiles and other goods.
2. Religion: Buddhist pilgrims and other religious travellers visited sacred places.
3. Education: Scholars came to learn from Indian teachers and centres of learning.
4. Culture: Travellers wanted to learn about Indian customs, traditions and ways of life.
5. Knowledge: Some came to study philosophy, science, mathematics and medicine.
6. Political reasons: Some rulers and armies came to establish control over territories.

Part 2: Important Questions and Answers from Every Topic

Topic 1: How Do We Define India?

Q1. What is India today?

Answer: India is a modern country with defined borders, states, a Constitution and a population.

Q2. Was India the same 2,000 or 5,000 years ago as it is today?

Answer: No. The boundaries and names of the region changed over time. The modern country of India developed through a long historical process.

Q3. What is the Indian Subcontinent?

Answer: The Indian Subcontinent is a large geographical region of Asia. It includes India and neighbouring countries such as Pakistan, Bangladesh, Nepal and Bhutan, along with other nearby areas depending on the definition used.

Q4. What are the natural boundaries of the Indian Subcontinent?

Answer: The Himalayas and other mountain ranges lie in the north. The Arabian Sea lies to the west, the Bay of Bengal to the east, and the Indian Ocean to the south.

Q5. How do we learn about the ancient names of India?

Answer: We learn about them from ancient texts, inscriptions, accounts of travellers and pilgrims, and other historical sources.

Q6. Why have the names and boundaries of India changed over time?

Answer: Different people and travellers used different names. Political changes, kingdoms, empires and cultural developments also influenced how the region was described.

Topic 2: How Indians Named India

Q1. What is the Rig Veda?

Answer: The Rig Veda is one of the oldest texts of India. It contains hymns and references to people, rivers and regions of ancient times.

Q2. What does ‘Sapta Sindhava’ mean?

Answer: ‘Sapta Sindhava’ means the land of the seven rivers. The Rig Veda used this name for the northwestern region of the Indian Subcontinent.

Q3. What is the meaning of ‘Sindhu’?

Answer: ‘Sindhu’ refers to the Indus River. In some contexts, it can also mean a river in general.

Q4. What is the connection between the words ‘Sindhu’ and ‘India’?

Answer: The name ‘India’ developed through forms of the word ‘Sindhu’ used by foreign peoples. The Persians used forms such as ‘Hind’ or ‘Hindu’, and the Greeks used ‘Indoi’ or ‘Indike’.

Q5. What does ‘Bharatavarsha’ mean?

Answer: ‘Bharatavarsha’ means the country of the Bharatas. It is an ancient name used for the Indian Subcontinent.

Q6. Who were the Bharatas?

Answer: The Bharatas were one of the important groups of people mentioned in the Rig Veda. The name later became associated with the larger region called Bharatavarsha.

Q7. What is Jambudvipa?

Answer: Jambudvipa is an ancient name for the Indian Subcontinent. It literally means the island or land associated with the fruit of the jamun tree.

Q8. Which tree is associated with the name Jambudvipa?

Answer: The jamun tree is associated with the name Jambudvipa.

Q9. Which ancient Indian text uses the names Bharatavarsha and Jambudvipa?

Answer: The Mahabharata uses both names.

Q10. Which ancient text describes Bharat as the land north of the ocean and south of the snowy mountains?

Answer: The Vishnu Purana gives this description of Bharat.

Q11. What are the “snowy mountains” mentioned in the Vishnu Purana?

Answer: They refer to the Himalayas.

Q12. Is the name Bharat still used today?

Answer: Yes. Bharat is still used as the name of India. It appears in the Constitution of India.

Topic 3: Emperor Ashoka and Jambudvipa

Q1. Who was Ashoka?

Answer: Ashoka was an ancient Indian emperor who ruled a large empire. He left many inscriptions on rocks and pillars.

Q2. How do Ashoka’s inscriptions help us understand ancient India?

Answer: Ashoka’s inscriptions provide information about his rule, messages, policies and the geographical region known as Jambudvipa.

Q3. What did Jambudvipa include during Ashoka’s time, according to the chapter?

Answer: It included the region of present-day India, parts of Afghanistan, Bangladesh and Pakistan.

Q4. Why are Ashoka’s inscriptions important historical sources?

Answer: They provide direct evidence from ancient times. Historians use them to understand the emperor’s messages, administration and the region under his rule.

Q5. Did the boundaries of ancient India match the present boundaries of India?

Answer: No. The geographical and political boundaries of ancient India were different from those of modern India.

Topic 4: How Foreigners Named India

Q1. Who were the first foreigners mentioned in the chapter to use a name derived from Sindhu for India?

Answer: The ancient Persians were among the first foreigners mentioned in the chapter to use names derived from Sindhu.

Q2. Why did the Persians use the words ‘Hind’, ‘Hidu’ or ‘Hindu’?

Answer: The Persians adapted the word ‘Sindhu’ to their own language. They used forms such as ‘Hind’, ‘Hidu’ and ‘Hindu’ for the region around the Indus River.

Q3. Did the ancient Persian word ‘Hindu’ refer to the Hindu religion?

Answer: No. In the ancient Persian context described in the chapter, it was a geographical term, not a reference to the Hindu religion.

Q4. What names did the ancient Greeks use for India?

Answer: The Greeks used names such as Indoi and Indike.

Q5. Why did the Greeks change ‘Hindu’ to ‘Indoi’ or ‘Indike’?

Answer: The initial ‘h’ sound was not present in the Greek language, so the Greeks dropped it.

Q6. What names did the ancient Chinese use for India?

Answer: The Chinese used names such as Yintu, Yindu and Tianzhu.

Q7. How was the Chinese name ‘Yindu’ connected to ‘Sindhu’?

Answer: The name developed through forms used by different peoples. The chapter shows the progression as Sindhu → Hindhu → Indu → Yindu.

Q8. What does ‘Tianzhu’ tell us about the Chinese view of India?

Answer: The word reflected the respect some ancient Chinese people had for India as the land of the Buddha.

Q9. Who was Xuanzang?

Answer: Xuanzang was a Chinese Buddhist scholar who travelled to India in the 7th century CE. He visited many places, met scholars, collected Buddhist texts and returned to China after 17 years.

Q10. Why did Xuanzang travel to India?

Answer: He travelled to study Buddhism, visit important places, meet scholars and collect Buddhist texts.

Q11. When was the name ‘Hindustan’ first used, according to the chapter?

Answer: The chapter says that ‘Hindustan’ first appeared in a Persian inscription about 1,800 years ago.

Q12. Did the name ‘India’ come from the name of a modern Indian state?

Answer: No. The name ‘India’ developed from forms of the ancient word ‘Sindhu’, used by foreign peoples.

Topic 5: “India, That Is Bharat” in the Constitution

Q1. What does the phrase “India, that is Bharat” mean?

Answer: It means that India and Bharat are two names for the same country.

Q2. Where can we find the phrase “India, that is Bharat”?

Answer: We can find it at the beginning of the Constitution of India.

Q3. What phrase is used in the Hindi version of the Constitution?

Answer: The Hindi version uses the phrase “भारत अर्थात् इंडिया” (Bharat arthath India).

Q4. What is a Constitution?

Answer: A Constitution is a document that lays down the basic principles, structure and laws of a nation.

Q5. When did the Constitution of India come into force?

Answer: The Constitution of India came into force on 26 January 1950.

Q6. Why is the name Bharat important?

Answer: Bharat is an ancient name that connects modern India with its long history and cultural traditions.

Topic 6: India in Ancient Tamil Literature

Q1. What does an ancient Tamil poem tell us about India?

Answer: The poem describes a king whose fame extended from Cape Kumari in the south to the great mountain in the north and from the eastern ocean to the western ocean.

Q2. What is Cape Kumari called today?

Answer: Cape Kumari is associated with Kanyakumari, at the southern tip of mainland India.

Q3. Which mountain is meant by “the great mountain in the north”?

Answer: It refers to the Himalayas.

Q4. What do ancient Indian texts and poems tell us about geographical knowledge?

Answer: They show that ancient Indians had knowledge of important rivers, mountains, regions and the seas surrounding the Subcontinent.

Q5. How do different ancient texts describe the extent of India?

Answer: Different texts use different descriptions. Some mention particular rivers and regions, while others describe a wider area from the Himalayas in the north to the ocean in the south.

Topic 7: Names of India in Different Languages

The following table summarises the names discussed in the chapter and the related language forms.

Language or people	Name used
Ancient Indian texts	Bharatavarsha, Jambudvipa, Sapta Sindhava
Persian	Hind, Hidu, Hindu
Greek	Indoi, Indike
Chinese	Yintu, Yindu, Tianzhu
English	India
French	Inde

Important note: These names belong to different periods and contexts. They did not all begin at the same time or refer to exactly the same geographical area.

Q1. How did the name India develop?

Answer: The name India developed from forms of the word Sindhu used by foreign peoples. Persian forms influenced the Greek name Indoi, and later forms developed in other languages.

Q2. Which language uses the name ‘Inde’?

Answer: French uses the name ‘Inde’.

Q3. Are Bharat and India names for two different countries?

Answer: No. Bharat and India are two names for the same country.

Part 3: Answers to “Let’s Explore” Activities

Activity 1: Identify natural boundaries from the physical map on page 76.

Answer:

The map shows the Indian Subcontinent surrounded by natural features:

- The Himalayas and other mountain ranges in the north.
- The Arabian Sea in the west.
- The Bay of Bengal in the east.
- The Indian Ocean in the south.

Activity 2: Identify regions mentioned in the Mahabharata on the map on page 79.

Sample Answer:

Some of the regions mentioned in the Mahabharata are:

- Kashmir
- Kurukshetra
- Vanga
- Pragjyotisha
- Kaccha or Kutch
- Kerala

These names are associated with regions of present-day India.

Activity 3: Identify “India, that is Bharat” on the first page of the Constitution on page 82.

Answer:

The phrase “India, that is Bharat” appears at the beginning of the Constitution of India. It shows that both names refer to the same country.

Activity 4: Complete the table of names of India.

Language	Name
Persian	Hind, Hidu, Hindu
Greek	Indoi, Indike
Latin	India
Chinese	Yintu, Yindu, Tianzhu
Arabic and Persian	Hindustan
English	India
French	Inde

Note: The table shows important forms of the names. Historical spellings and usage may vary across periods.

Part 4: Additional Important Questions for Examinations

Very Short Answer Questions

Q1. What is the oldest Indian text mentioned in the chapter?

Answer: The Rig Veda.

Q2. What does Sapta Sindhava mean?

Answer: The land of the seven rivers.

Q3. What does Bharatavarsha mean?

Answer: The country of the Bharatas.

Q4. What is Jambudvipa associated with?

Answer: The jamun tree.

Q5. Which emperor used the name Jambudvipa in an inscription?

Answer: Emperor Ashoka.

Q6. Which text describes Bharat as lying south of the snowy mountains?

Answer: The Vishnu Purana.

Q7. Which river is associated with the word Sindhu?

Answer: The Indus River.

Q8. Which Chinese scholar visited India in the 7th century CE?

Answer: Xuanzang.

Q9. Which two names for India appear in the Constitution?

Answer: India and Bharat.

Q10. What does the word ‘Hindu’ mean in the ancient Persian context of this chapter?

Answer: It is a geographical name derived from Sindhu.

Short Answer Questions

Q1. Why is the Rig Veda important for the history of India?

Answer: The Rig Veda is one of India's oldest texts. It contains references to ancient people, rivers and regions. It helps historians understand early Indian society and geography.

Q2. Explain the difference between Bharatavarsha and Jambudvipa.

Answer: Both are ancient names associated with the Indian Subcontinent. Bharatavarsha means the country of the Bharatas, while Jambudvipa means the land or island associated with the jamun tree.

Q3. How did foreign travellers influence the names of India?

Answer: Foreign travellers and writers used names derived from Sindhu. These names changed according to their languages, giving rise to forms such as Hindu, Indoi, Yindu and India.

Q4. Why are inscriptions useful for studying ancient India?

Answer: Inscriptions provide written evidence from the past. They help historians learn about rulers, territories, policies and the names used for regions.

Q5. Why should we study the different names of India?

Answer: The different names help us understand India's history, geography and cultural connections with other regions of the world.

Long Answer Questions

Q1. Explain the different ancient names of India and their meanings.

Answer:

India has had several names throughout history. The Rig Veda mentions Sapta Sindhava, meaning the land of the seven rivers. Bharatavarsha means the country of the Bharatas, while Jambudvipa is associated with the jamun tree. The Mahabharata uses the names Bharatavarsha and Jambudvipa. The Vishnu Purana describes Bharat as the land north of the ocean and south of the snowy mountains. Foreigners used forms such as Hind, Hindu, Indoi, Yindu and India. Today, both India and Bharat are official names of our country.

Q2. Explain how the name India developed from the word Sindhu.

Answer:

Sindhu was the ancient Indian name for the Indus River. The Persians adapted the word into forms such as Hind, Hidu and Hindu. The Greeks used names such as Indoi and Indike, dropping the initial ‘h’ sound. The Chinese also used forms such as Yindu and Yintu. Over time, the name India became widely used in English and other languages.

Q3. What sources help us learn about the ancient names and geography of India?

Answer:

We learn about ancient India through literary texts, inscriptions, maps and accounts of travellers and pilgrims. The Rig Veda mentions Sapta Sindhava. The Mahabharata refers to Bharatavarsha, Jambudvipa and several regions. The Vishnu Purana describes the location of Bharat. Ashoka's inscriptions provide evidence about the use of Jambudvipa. Accounts of travellers such as Xuanzang provide information about India's people, learning and religious traditions.

Q4. Explain the importance of the phrase “India, that is Bharat”.

Answer:

The phrase “India, that is Bharat” appears at the beginning of the Constitution of India. It shows that India and Bharat are names for the same country. Bharat is an ancient name that connects modern India with its history and cultural heritage. The phrase also reflects the country's constitutional identity.

Part 5: Important Facts to Remember

Fact	Answer
Ancient name meaning “land of the seven rivers”	Sapta Sindhava
Ancient name meaning “country of the Bharatas”	Bharatavarsha
Name associated with the jamun tree	Jambudvipa
Ancient river associated with the names Hindu and India	Sindhu or Indus

Ancient Indian emperor associated with inscriptions using Jambudvipa	Ashoka
Text that mentions Bharatavarsha and Jambudvipa	Mahabharata
Text describing Bharat as north of the ocean and south of the snowy mountains	Vishnu Purana
Ancient Greek names	Indoi, Indike
Ancient Chinese names	Yindu, Yintu, Tianzhu
Chinese scholar who visited India in the 7th century CE	Xuanzang
Names used in the Constitution	India and Bharat
Date the Constitution of India came into force	26 January 1950

Part 6: Important Definitions

Word	Simple meaning
Indian Subcontinent	A large geographical region of Asia that includes India and neighbouring areas
Inhabitant	A person who lives in a particular place
Inscription	Writing carved or written on stone, metal or another surface
Constitution	A document that sets out the basic principles and laws of a nation
Sapta Sindhava	The land of the seven rivers
Bharatavarsha	The country of the Bharatas
Jambudvipa	An ancient name associated with the jamun tree and the Indian Subcontinent
Sindhu	The Indus River; sometimes used for a river in general
Pilgrim	A person who travels to a sacred place
Cultural unity	A sense of connection through shared traditions, beliefs and practices

Exam preparation tip: Focus especially on the meanings of Sapta Sindhava, Bharatavarsha and Jambudvipa; the development of the names Sindhu, Hindu and India; the contributions of the Rig Veda, Mahabharata, Vishnu Purana and Ashoka's inscriptions; and the phrase “India, that is Bharat” in the Constitution.